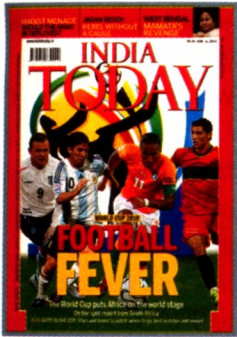


Football Fever

JUNE 14, 2010

Half a kilo of ball and half the world watching. The World Cup has come to the high places of South Africa and 32 teams will go for goals for the greatest prize in world sports today. Fasten your seatbelts.



“The World Cup is a platform to watch great players display their magical skills. One wonders if its magnificence can inspire the All India Football Federation to take Indian soccer to the international level.”

DR SANJIV GUPTA, *Perth, Australia*

The Goal Rush

Sharda Ugra's coverage of the football World Cup was elaborate ("Football Fever", June 14). It holds a soccer fan's interest as she goes on to give details of the teams' jerseys, boots, the dazzling trophy and their unsung heroes, including South Africa that is participating after a gap of four decades. The cover story is first of its kind in print media during my long stint as a soccer fan. In spite of witnessing thrilling moments during the matches, many fans will actually fall back on your soccer coverage and examine the various possibilities that you have talked about.

PROF RAMESH SINHA, *Delhi*

World Cup 2010 fever has caught the world. And "the Cup that cheers the world"



Weapons of Maoist Destruction

It is high time we defined a clear-cut policy to fight against the Naxals ("Weapon of Last Resort", June 14). Army intervention may not be directly necessary, but it can provide infrastructural support to the Central paramilitary forces. More forces should be sent to the Naxal-affected areas and deployment should be done as per operational requirements, not according to the police.

RISHA CHAUDHARY, *Lucknow*

Whatever the Naxals' grouse against the system may be, destruction of public property and killing civilians cannot be tolerated. Considering the attitude of the governments, both at the Centre and in the affected states, the risk of Maoism spreading throughout India is substantial.

M. KUMAR, *via www.indiatoday.in*

has put South Africa on the spotlight and the continent as a whole shines. But what about India that holds the 133rd rank in FIFA? Will it enthuse and inspire the youth in a manner so that we can even aspire to qualify for the World Cup any time? We have to create the right atmosphere and encourage the sport among our youngsters.

A. JACOB SAHAYAM,
Thiruvananthapuram

All for Didigiri

It is evident that a maverick Mamata Banerjee has eminently succeeded in pricking the Marxist bubble of invincibility in its own backyard with the overwhelming performance of her party ("The Didi Wave", June 14). The victory, however, should also be seen as an anti-

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